



MONTHLY UPDATE

Senegal: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27-2 · 68 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The tax authority [withdrew the paper fiscal stamp on 20 July 2026](#), making the digital service the sole recognised channel. Eight days later a free electronic stamp service [suspended its free tier, citing an administrative decision outside its control](#); users state they now pay additional fees for an identical service.

Civil registration published its clearest figures yet: [437 of 629 centres fully deployed](#) and [15.3m records loaded](#). The audit court then [opened a mission across 74 communes covering 2018 to 2025](#).

Three policy instruments surfaced, none of them readable: an [AI strategy adopted in 2023](#), a [national data strategy cited as adopted](#), and a [national AI development plan instructed for deployment on 29 July](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The same account is the first to record a [national data strategy as adopted](#); its text is not on file and its adoption date is not established.

Two further AI instruments entered the record. A readiness assessment of 26 July records an [AI strategy adopted in 2023 on six orientations](#), correcting the base's earlier reading that no published strategy existed; the council of ministers communiqué of [29 July records an instruction to deploy a national AI development plan](#). Whether the plan supersedes or replaces the 2023 strategy is unestablished. A [blueprint for value creation through data](#) reached working-group stage on 1 and 2 July.

The telecommunications ministry [put a national online child-protection action plan in place on nine axes](#); an automated fetch on 31 July found no document on the ministry's own site.

Legislation and regulation

The critical-infrastructure framework that was undated at the end of July reached parliament a fortnight later. A bill on protecting critical information infrastructure and digital security [was presented to the National Assembly's intercommission on 13 August and examined by its committees](#), proposing a [national cybersecurity authority](#), [national and sectoral computer emergency response teams](#), and [obligations on critical operators graded by risk](#), alongside [local hosting of public data](#), [service continuity](#) and [personal-data protection](#) under the state's technology-deal agenda. Four days later the ministry published its own account of the contents: obligations [graded by risk, with](#)

ordinary networks on standard requirements and critical infrastructure on enhanced ones — monitoring, data backup, encryption of sensitive information, business continuity and disaster recovery, and regular resilience testing — and a National Cybersecurity Authority, a national response team, sectoral teams and cybersecurity operations services, with an industrial objective attached: the ministry expects the compliance requirement itself to create accredited service providers, domestic firms and skilled jobs. It cleared on 20 August: the National Assembly adopted law n° 25/2026 unanimously, mandating in-country storage of state-sensitive data, empowering the National Cybersecurity Authority and folding in technology-neutral standards for the AI era and the child-online-protection plan, seven days after it reached the intercommission. In the same debate the Assembly's first vice-president argued cybersecurity has to become a standing administrative culture, calling for mandatory staff training, professional-only communication channels and minimum device-security standards - a description of where the state's own practice stands rather than of what the law requires. Every provision is still the ministry's description; the text is not held, no promulgation date or gazette reference is published, and nothing the law creates exists yet.

Data protection

The data-protection reform reached a [finalisation workshop for the bill and its implementing decree, rewritten against the data and AI strategies](#), with no adoption date or published text.

Regional collaboration

Regionally, Senegal became [one of 29 founding states of an intergovernmental AI-governance body on 16 July](#), and joined the approval on 31 July of [three ECOWAS statistical methodological guides](#).

The bilateral channel moved from signature to work. The June 2026 telecommunications and digital-economy memorandum with the Gambia [went into implementation around four priorities — connectivity, cybersecurity, skills and digital transformation — with the telecommunications and digital minister travelling to Banjul to agree the first joint work, and the two regulators separately deepening cooperation on frequency coordination, service quality and cross-border roaming](#). What Senegal supplies in that relationship is transit: the Gambia's terrestrial fibre build is limited and it depends largely on a single submarine cable for international access, with only limited terrestrial redundancy through Senegal. No work programme, budget or timetable is published.

Standards

Senegal adopted [non-binding Francophone West African AI governance guidelines on 6 July](#).

Senegal held its [first national green-coding and responsible-digital workshop](#), bringing about 170 people from the sector to Dakar on 18 and 19 August 2026 to set the basis for a national approach to digital sobriety. Nothing was adopted at it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

A ministry legal adviser stated that the state has [worked on social-media regulation since 2024](#) with no bill or timetable named.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The constraint on that deployment is money, and the agency said so itself. On 17 August its director-general said [the agency's 2026 budget had still not been notified](#), and named that as what is holding back the pace of the Kaolack phase — the deployment of the civil-status software and activation of the citizen request platform across Nioro, Ndiedieng and Kaolack between 10 and 20 August. The base holds no appropriation figure for the agency for 2026, which is recorded as a gap.

New investments

A [US\\$50m pre-seed and seed fund was announced on a conference stage in Paris on 20 June](#), with public capital framed as crowding in private investors. No first close, limited partners, fund manager or deployment is held.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A [teleport gateway entered service, reported 10 July, with sixteen new antennas and a Tier III room](#) linking a low-orbit constellation to terrestrial networks.

Two financing items arrived within a week. On 13 July a development bank [extended a senior facility of up to EUR 270m, EUR 170m committed, for 4G, 5G and fibre in Senegal and Kenya](#) — its first Senegal project, with Senegal's share not disaggregated. On 16 July a presidential meeting produced an [announced intent of US\\$150m from a tower operator](#), with no signed agreement or schedule; the account traces solely to the Presidency, and trade press moved from *plans* to *commitment* in a day with no new evidence.

A measurement covering January to July put [mobile latency at 35.4 ms, second in sub-Saharan Africa behind Togo at 28.8 ms](#); no prior Senegal figure is held.

Technical Capacity

A continental count puts [seven data centres in Senegal at mid-2025, level with Ghana, against South Africa's 56, Kenya's 19 and Nigeria's 17](#). It is a reference figure, cited and not absorbed: the base holds no Senegalese primary count and no capacity figure at all.

Cybersecurity

On 30 July the procurement authority and the ministry [floated three routes for buying critical-infrastructure cybersecurity](#) — a three-year standing supplier arrangement, functional specifications, and pooled purchasing — with no timetable or contract value. The state's own diagnosis locates the blockage in procurement, not in budget.

The offence figures the case for all this rests on moved barely at all: national police recorded [3,794 cybercrime offences in 2025 against 3,902 in 2024](#), reported alongside an international police organisation's estimate of at least US\$5bn in Africa-wide losses over the same year. Neither the recording basis nor a clear-up rate is stated.

DPI

Data Exchange

A government enterprise-architecture account of 3 August records [platforms still siloed sixteen months after the interoperability platform launched](#), with the architecture to be fed by a full inventory of national digital systems. Four narrower exchanges moved in the same weeks: a [workshop on 23 July to diagnose social-protection systems](#), the minister stating each structure runs its own system and cannot share data; a [climate-transparency data project launched on 22 July over 42 months](#); a [three-month customs roadmap with Gambia](#); and a [convention to interconnect the digital agency and the health-cover platform](#), whose personal-data commitment was not referred to the regulator.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Consolidated agency data at 17 July records [437 of 629 civil-status centres fully deployed](#), [112 of them running the citizen-facing service](#); on 13 July the agency reported [15.3m records loaded](#).

Deployment moved again in August, and the agency put a frame around it. At African Civil Registration Day in Kaolack on 10 August it [launched phase four of its remediation plan and put deployment at 74% of centres, up from 70% five days earlier, with the citizen request platform live in 189 communes](#), phase four extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda; its director-general described civil registration as an instrument of sovereignty.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Digital settlement on the Dakar rapid-transit network reached [39% after a super-app was integrated on 15 July](#), against 10% previously, on a network carrying up to 300,000 passengers daily.

Registries

On 28 July an audit mission [launched across 74 communes, 59 already audited and fifteen selected on risk analysis](#); no findings are stated. On 30 July the mines ministry and the deposits fund [signed a convention commissioning professional cards and a nationwide database of artisanal gold miners](#), with no enrolment target, host or data-protection provision reported.

The digitisation the audit is measuring has its own figures. The civil-status agency [puts 471 of 629 centres digitised, 43% activation of the citizen portal and 15,352,830 records centralised on pilot data at 13 July](#), with a remediation push at Kaolack from 10 to 20 August before extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda. The figures are the agency's own and no national completion date is stated; the gap between three quarters of centres digitised and two in five citizens activating the portal is the one the remediation is aimed at.

Sectoral management information systems

In health, a [mortality and cause-of-death analysis tool was trained out on 20 and 21 July](#), and civil society [called on 23 July for adoption of a digital-health bill](#) whose status and text are not stated; the ministry has begun building a single patient record ahead of the law meant to govern it.

The higher-education, research and innovation ministry [reported a further step in the digital transformation of its services](#), framed around interoperability; no service list, user count or completion date is given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The month's clearest movement is a removal rather than an addition. The tax authority [withdrew the paper fiscal stamp on 20 July, making the digital service the sole recognised channel nationwide](#), with QR-coded stamps bought and received remotely. Unused paper stamps were exchangeable until 15 August and no offline or assisted route is

stated. Eight days later the [free electronic stamp service was suspended by its provider, citing an administrative decision outside its control, with refunds promised within 72 hours and users stating they now pay additional fees for an identical service](#) — the first consumer-cost consequence of state-platform exclusivity the base holds, and it is not stated whether the decision was addressed to that provider or to the distribution channel generally. Separately the state procurement platform is [operating and named by the procurement regulator as intended to capture the procedures of a thousand administrations](#), with its protection a stated priority alongside critical state digital infrastructure; no count of administrations onboarded, procurement volume, availability record or security accreditation is given.

Parliament's own systems entered the record for the first time, and only as a purchase order: on 5 August the United Nations development programme [opened a tender to supply IT equipment for the National Assembly's SIPOP system](#). What that system does, what it costs and when it runs are all absent from the notice, which is the whole of what the base holds on it.

Technology

AI

A national prize ceremony on 30 July presented a [Wolof and French AI tutor reachable by ordinary phone call with no internet, its curriculum validated by school inspectors and hosted on servers in Senegal](#). No user, pricing or evaluation figure is given, and the education ministry's role is asserted by the vendor rather than confirmed by it. The same readiness assessment records an [ethics committee as planned](#), with no statute, membership or chair. The state's own AI build was presented abroad rather than at home: the Senegal AI Factory was [set out to an international AI-process meeting in Tokyo as the main component of the Senegal Digital Factory under the technology strategy's eighth priority programme, covering national AI capability, startups, applied research and training](#), with no launch date, budget, compute location or partner commitment stated.

What none of it runs under is a statute. A four-country comparative study presented on 10 August [found no AI-specific legislation in force or in draft in Senegal](#), leaving the strategy stack and an ethics committee that is still only planned to carry the field between them.

Innovation ecosystem

On 14 July the transit and telecommunications operators [signed a partnership for progressive integration of ticketing and top-ups](#), with no go-live date published, and a [corporate mobility platform launched on 16 July](#).

Capacity

Literacy

A digital financial-education project [closed on 15 July](#) having trained 265 civil-society trainers across twelve organisations. Its comparison platform is left unmaintained, because no implementer can compel tariff data from financial institutions.

Training and skills

Two facts about the state's own capacity arrived in the same week and point opposite ways. The national statistics agency [graduated 60 statisticians - 33 statistician-economists and 27 statistician-analysts, drawn from ten African countries - taking its school's cumulative output past 900 since 2011](#), and used the ceremony to press ministries to recruit them into sectoral statistical services: an absorption problem stated rather than measured, since no figure is published for how many of the 900 work in Senegalese public statistics. Against it, the National Assembly [voted](#)

129-0 to open a commission of inquiry into about 48 billion FCFA committed since 2017 under the student-computer programme, over alleged procurement breaches and 800 defective machines stored unused at the country's largest university. The programme has run for nine years and publishes no delivery total, unit cost or student-reach figure, so the inquiry's envelope is the only quantity the record holds about it.

Research institutions

The council of ministers of 29 July proposed a national research and innovation fund alongside applied research laboratories. Neither is an adopted instrument, and no budget or date attaches to either.

Inclusion

Access to services

An advanced-level digital course for blind and partially sighted people opened on 6 July, on a programme reporting 700 people and twenty trainers trained since its launch. The launch date is not stated, so the cumulative figure has no start point.

Digital divides

The month's one inclusion measure came from the despatch box rather than a survey. Debating the critical-infrastructure bill, the telecommunications minister told parliament that 40% of Senegalese still have no access to connectivity, citing a 2024 sector diagnosis of coverage gaps and unmet operator obligations. The diagnosis itself is not held, no definition of access accompanies the figure, and it is two years old at the point of its citation.

Data

National statistics

The statistics agency hosted the first peer exchange of an inclusive-data initiative's second phase in Dakar, widening it from three countries to five. The exchange's exact dates are not published, so the position carries month precision only.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The digital minister pitched the technology strategy in Washington, holding working sessions on financing mechanisms for digital infrastructure, data centres, digital identity and payment systems. No financier, amount or instrument was reported.

China activities

The sovereign cloud is in testing, with data-centre infrastructure deployed and verified for redundancy and reliability to host sensitive national data on Senegalese territory, accelerated ahead of an international sporting event. No contract, value, hosting term, exit arrangement or data-access terms are reported — a sovereignty claim resting on a vendor relationship whose terms are not held.

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